MIL-C-25531D
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SUPERSEDING
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9 Nov 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

COUPLING HALF, QUICK DISCONNECT, PNEUMATIC STARTER, EXTERNAL, LOW PRESSURE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for quick-disconnect external low pressure half couplings for a pneumatic starter. Couplings shall have primary and secondary methods of release, with automatic pressure lock and self-closing valves.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

RR-C-271	Chains and Attachments, Welded and Weldless.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
DOD-D-1000	Drawing, Engineering and Associated List.
* MIL-S-7742	Screw Threads, Standard, Optimum Selected Series, General Specification for.
MIL-A-8625	Anodic Coatings, for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MIL-D-22706	Duct and Scuff Cover, Pneumatic, Flexible.
MIL-N-25027	Nut, Self-Locking, 250°F, 450°F, and 800°F.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: the Engineering Division, SA-ALC/MMEDO, Kelly Air Force Base, TX 78241 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 4730

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- STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129	Marking for shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.
MIL-STD-143	Standards and Specifications Order of Precedence for the Selection of.
MIL-STD-147	Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-889	Dissimilar Metals.
MS17833	Fitting, Pneumatic Starter, Duct-Flanged (Male).
MS18072	Ring Handling, Air Start Coupling.
MS20995	Wire, Lock.
MS33540	Safety Wiring, General Practices for.
MS33740	Nipple, Pneumatic Starting, 3 Inch ID, Outline Dimensions of.
MS35338	Washer, Lock-spring, Helical, Regular (Medium) Series.
MS90727	Screw, Cap, Hexagon Head (Finished Hexagon Bolt), Alloy Steel, Grade 8, Cadmium Plated, UNF-2A, Plain and Self Locking.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the non-government documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D-3951	Packaging Commercial.

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Uniform Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 202, Union Station, 516 West Jackson Blvd, Chicago, IL 60606.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. The coupling furnished under this specification shall be a product which has been tested and has passed the qualification tests specified herein, and has been listed on or approved for listing on the applicable Qualified Products List.

3.2 Selection of specifications and standards. Specifications and standards for necessary commodities and services not specified herein shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-143, except as specified in 3.2.1 and 3.2.2.

3.2.1 Commercial parts. Commercial parts having suitable properties may be used where, on the date of invitation for bids, there are no suitable standard parts. In any case, commercial utility parts, such as screws, bolts, nuts, and cotter pins, having suitable properties may be used provided:

a. They can be replaced by the standard parts (MS or AN) without alteration.

b. The corresponding standard part numbers are referenced in the parts list and, if practical, on the contractor's drawings.

3.2.2 Standard parts. With the exception specified in 3.2.1, MS and AN standard parts shall be used where they suit the purpose. They shall be identified on the drawings by their part numbers.

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Fungus-proof materials. Materials that are nutrients for fungi shall not be used where it is practical to avoid them. Where used and not hermetically sealed, they shall be treated with a fungicidal agent acceptable to the procuring activity. However, if they will be used in a hermetically sealed inclosure, fungicidal treatment will not be necessary.

3.3.2 Metals. Metals shall be of the corrosion-resistant type or suitably treated to resist corrosion due to fuels, salt spray, or atmospheric conditions which may be encountered in storage or normal service.

3.3.2.1 Dissimilar metals. Unless suitably protected against electrolytic corrosion, dissimilar metals shall not be used in intimate contact with each other. Dissimilar metals are defined in MIL-STD-889.

* 3.3.3 Reclaimed materiels. The use of reclaimed materiels shall be encouraged to the maximum extent possible.

3.4 Design. The coupling shall conform dimensionally to figure 1 and shall be in accordance with the following requirements. One end of the coupling shall mate with the MS33740 nipple and the other end shall mate with the flange of hose and fitting MS17833. No part of the coupling shall protrude into the nipple bore. Three holes shall be provided as stated in paragraph 3.5.2 for possible attachment of MS18072 handling ring.

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3.4.1 Reliability. The coupling shall be designed and constructed as specified herein in a manner that will insure the highest degree of operational reliability under all service conditions.

3.4.2 Instructions. Brief appropriate operating instructions such as "TURN TO LOCK," or a directional arrow shall be provided as a permanent part of the coupling, preferably a part of the outer coupling casting.

3.5 Construction. The coupling shall be so constructed that it will withstand the strains, jars, vibrations, and other conditions incident to installation and service usage.

3.5.1 Maintainability. The coupling shall have a minimum number of parts consistent with reliability. Its design shall permit easy assembly, disassembly, location of trouble sources, and maintenance with tools normally available commercially, by service maintenance personnel with a minimum of training.

3.5.2 Handling ring (MS18072) attachment holes. The actuating sleeve (collar) shall contain three holes. The holes shall be spaced 120 degrees apart, circumferentially, with one of the holes located 180 degrees circumferentially from the point of lanyard attachment. Each hole shall be located axially 1.75 inches from the face of the flanged end of the coupling and shall be tapped for 5/16 - 24UNF - 2B threads of MIL-S-7742 to a minimum depth of 0.375 inch. The drilled holes should be plugged with MS90727-27 hex cap screw. A set of two(2) MS35338-45 washers should be used in conjunction with each bolt.

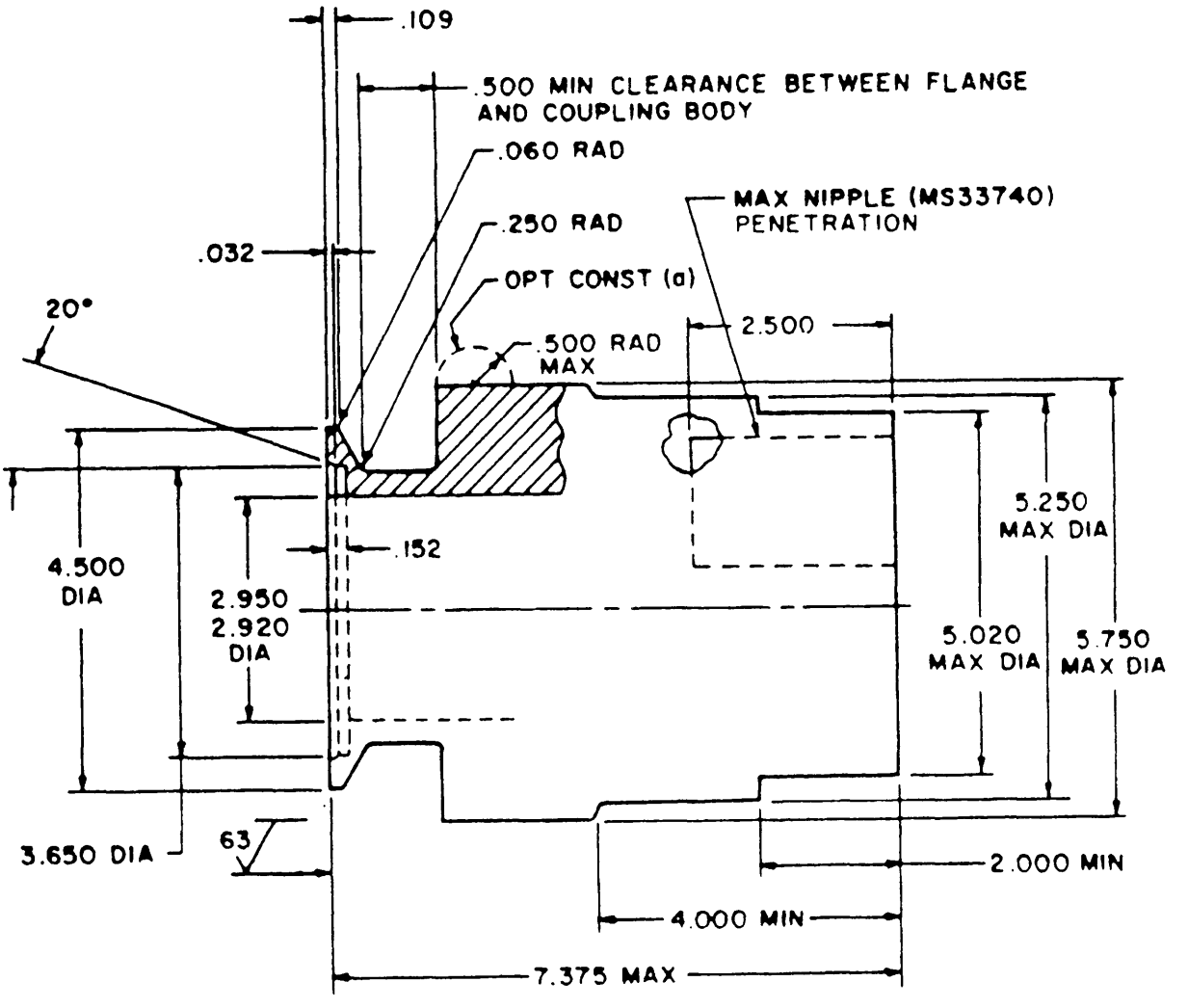
3.6 Locking of parts. All threaded parts shall be locked by safety wiring, by self-locking nuts conforming to MIL-N-25027, cotter pin, or other approved methods. Safety wire shall be installed in accordance with MS33540 and shall conform to MS20995. The use of lockwashers, set screws or staking is not permitted unless specifically approved by the using service, However, staking shall not be used where failure of the staking will allow any loose part in the flow stream.

3.6.1 Coupling to fitting connection. Provision shall be made for positive locking of the hose fitting to the coupling. The lock shall be of a reusable type.

3.7 Performance. The coupling shall function equally well with air flowing in either direction and shall satisfy the applicable requirements when tested in accordance with 4.6.

3.8 Attachment. The force required to engage the coupling to the nipple shall not exceed 25 pounds or a maximum torque of 25 lb-ft, as applicable. Attachment means shall be such that both hands of the operator are free to apply the necessary torque. The coupling shall be so constructed that it will not become partially locked on the nipple allowing it to come off during operation. Pulling on the hose normally connected to the coupling shall not result in disengagement of the coupling.

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(a) PROTUBERANCE SHALL NOT EXTEND MORE THAN 2 INCHES ALONG CIRCUMFERENCE AT OUTSIDE RADIUS OF BODY OF COUPLING.

FLANGE FITTING END PIECE TO MATE WITH FLANGE OF MS17833.

DIMENSIONS IN INCHES. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, TOLERANCES: ±.010 INCH.

FIGURE 1. Coupling half, quick disconnect, pneumatic starter, external, low pressure.

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3.9 Release. The coupling shall contain two methods of release from the airframe nipple, a primary and secondary release.

3.9.1 Primary. Primary release of the coupling shall be a single 18 inch long lanyard-type release requiring a steady force of 10 to 40 pounds to release the coupling from the airframe nipple. The lanyard shall be constructed of chain complying with or equivalent to RR-C-271, type I, grade C, class 5, style 2, zinc coated, 1/8 inch (Trade No. 4) size with a T-type handle attached to the free end. End connecting links shall be of equivalent welded and zinc coated steel wire. The handle and 2 inches of chain adjacent to the handle shall be covered with a heat-resistant plastic or rubber covering.

3.9.2 Disconnect. The coupling shall disconnect from the nipple when the lanyard release is pulled within a minimum angular cone of 30 degrees of the coupling axis when the coupling is mounted in any position on the aircraft.

3.9.3 Secondary. A secondary release independent of the primary release (lanyard) shall be provided. This secondary release may include pulling or rotating of the outer collar of the coupling.

3.9.4 Safety device. An automatic pressure lock and a self-closing automatic mechanical safety valve shall be provided for safety of operation. The pressure lock shall immobilize the primary lanyard and secondary release when the coupling is in the engaged position and under pressure. The pressure lock shall be so located that it is always accessible without disassembly of the coupling for manual deactivation while the coupling is connected to the nipple. The automatic pressure lock shall prevent disconnect of the coupling when the pressure is above 10 psi. It shall only be necessary for the valve to sufficiently stop the air flow to prevent danger to operating personnel. The device incorporated shall not be adversely affected by gravitational forces.

3.10 Interchangeability. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be functionally and dimensionally interchangeable. The drawing number requirements of DOD-D-1000 shall govern changes in the manufacturer's part numbers.

3.11 Dimensions. The dimensions of the coupling shall be as shown in figure 1.

3.12 Weight. The weight of the coupling shall be the minimum consistent with the required performance, but shall not exceed 10 pounds.

3.13 Finishes and protective coatings.

3.13.1 Finishes. The couplings shall have no painted surfaces.

3.13.2 Protective coatings. The couplings shall be adequately protected against corrosion by the use of material or protective coatings acceptable to the procuring activity.

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3.13.2.1 Anodizing. All aluminum-alloy parts shall be anodized in accordance with MIL-A-8625.

3.14 Identification of product. Equipment, assemblies, and parts shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.15 Workmanship. The coupling shall be uniform in quality, clean, sound, smooth, and free from injurious defects.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of tests. The inspection and testing of the couplings shall be classified as follows:

a. Qualification tests (see 4.3).

b. Quality conformance test (see 4.4).

4.3 Qualification tests. The qualification tests shall consist of all the tests specified under 4.6 and conducted in the order listed.

4.3.1 Sampling instructions. The qualification test samples submitted for Government tests shall consist of two couplings of each manufacturer's part number upon which qualification is desired. Samples submitted shall be accompanied by a report of the completed qualification test and shall be identified with the manufacturer's part number and any additional information required by the letter of authorization.

4.4 Quality conformance tests. Quality conformance tests shall consist of individual tests and sampling tests.

4.4.1 Individual tests. Each coupling shall be subjected to examination of product (see 4.6.1).

4.4.2 Sampling tests.

4.4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of couplings of the same part number manufactured under essentially the same conditions and submitted for inspection at the same time.

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4.4.2.2 Sampling. One coupling shall be selected at random from each lot of 50 or fraction thereof and subjected to the following tests:

a. Engagement and release (see 4.6.2).

b. Pressure (4.6.3)

c. Preservation, packaging, packing and marking (see 4.7).

4.4.3 Rejection and retest. When one or more couplings from a lot fail to meet the specification, acceptance of all couplings in the lot will be withheld until the extent and cause of failure are determined. After corrections have been made, all necessary tests shall be repeated.

4.4.3.1 Individual tests may continue. For production reasons, individual tests may be continued pending the investigation of a sampling test failure. Final acceptance of the entire lot shall not be made until it is determined that the lot meets all the requirements of this specification.

4.4.3.2 Defects in couplings already accepted. The investigation of a test failure could indicate that defects may exist in couplings already accepted. If so, the contractor shall fully advise the procuring activity of all defects likely to be found and methods of correcting them.

4.5 Test conditions.

4.5.1 Standard atmospheric conditions. Unless otherwise specified, tests shall be made at atmospheric pressure (approximately 29.92 inches of mercury) and at room temperature (approximately 77°F). When tests are made where atmospheric pressure or room temperature differ materially from these values, proper allowance shall be made for the difference from the specified condition.

4.5.2 Unless otherwise specified, a total of 10 cycles shall be accomplished for all release tests.

4.5.3 Lubrication. No lubrication or other servicing of the coupling or mating nipple shall be permitted throughout the test program.

4.5.4 Test nipple. In all tests where a nipple is required, the nipple shall be in accordance with MS33740.

4.5.5 Ducting. Where ducting is attached to the coupling for test purposes, the hose end fitting shall conform to MS17833 and the ducting shall conform to MIL-D-22706.

4.6 Test methods.

4.6.1 Examination of product. The coupling shall be examined to determine compliance with respect to materials, workmanship, dimensions and marking.

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4.6.2 Engagement and release. The coupling shall engage a nipple when a maximum force of 25 pounds or a maximum torque of 25 lb-ft, as applicable, is exerted. The coupling shall release from the nipple by the secondary method when a force of 10 to 40 pounds is exerted. The coupling shall disconnect from the nipple when the lanyard release is pulled with a force of 10 to 40 pounds within a minimum cone angle of 30 degrees.

4.6.3 Pressure. The coupling, mounted on a test nipple, shall be pressure tested at the pressures listed below. Each pressure shall be held for 5 minutes. Leakage shall not exceed 1 pound per minute (pm). The coupling shall be capable of normal operation after completion of this test.

a. Operating pressure - 112 psia at 600°F.

b. Proof pressure - 200 psia at 600°F.

4.6.4 Pressure drop. Pressure drop through the coupling, when attached to the nipple, shall not exceed 0.9 psi when 450°F air is supplied at 55 psi static pressure and 120 pm flow.

4.6.5 Temperature operation. The coupling shall be engaged and disengaged with a nipple at the following temperatures. Failure to successfully engage and disengage a total of five consecutive times for each temperature condition shall be cause for rejection.

a. Nipple and coupling at -65°F.

b. Nipple at -65°F and the coupling at +600°F internal surface temperature.

c. Nipple at 400°F and coupling at 600°F internal surface temperature.

4.6.6 Drop tests. The coupling, while attached to ducting shall be engaged with a nipple mounted in a horizontal position 6 feet above a concrete surface as measured from the centerline of the nipple. The internal surface temperature of the coupling shall be raised to 600°F. The coupling shall be disconnected by tripping the lanyard release and allowing it to fall on the concrete surface. This cycle shall be repeated 125 times with the coupling being rotated 72 degrees after every 25 drops and reheated to an internal surface temperature of 600°F after every 25 consecutive drops. This procedure shall be repeated for 125 disconnects when the coupling and nipple are mounted in the vertical position with the flange and nipple 6 feet above the surface. Upon completion of this test, the coupling shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.6.3.

4.6.7 Safety device.

4.6.7.1 Safety valve. The proper and reliable operation of the automatic self-closing valve shall be demonstrated in accordance with 4.5.2. The coupling attached to one end of a 10- to 30-foot length of ducting shall be placed on level concrete with the duct making a large radius angle of 90 degrees and the coupling end free to move. Air at 112 psia shall be applied to the duct. After initial straightening of the duct, there shall be no perceptible movement of the coupling end of the duct. The proper operation of

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the safety valve shall be demonstrated by the following procedure. With the pressure lock deactivated, the coupling attached to the nipple, and with air flowing under a pressure of 80 psia and stabilized at 600°F, lanyard actuation of the coupling shall cause the coupling to disconnect and instantaneously close the safety valve. As a safety precaution, the coupling end of the house shall be suitably restrained.

4.6.7.2 Pressure lock. The coupling, engaged with a nipple, shall be subjected to 112 psia. The lanyard release shall be pulled in an attempt to disconnect the coupling. The pressure shall be reduced in increments of 10 psi and at each increment the lanyard shall be tripped 3 times with sufficient force to provide a component parallel to the coupling axis of 25 to 35 pounds. Disconnection of the coupling when a pressure above 10 psi is applied or failure of the pressure lock to operate satisfactorily as a result of this test shall be cause for rejection.

4.6.8 Endurance. The coupling shall satisfactorily complete the following endurance test, after which it shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.6.3. Only one nipple shall be used throughout this test. Any galling or distortion of the nipple that would be detrimental to proper engagement or release of the coupling shall be cause for rejection.

a. Cyclical: The coupling shall be engaged and disengaged to the nipple a total of 1,000 times. The engagement and disengagement shall be accomplished after the coupling has been subjected for 1 minute to an air flow of 100 to 188 pm at a total air pressure and temperature of 80 psia and 500°F, respectively. The cycle shall be conducted at intervals of approximately 4 minutes.

b. Continuous: The coupling shall be subjected to 50 cycles, each cycle being 2 hours duration. During 1 hour of the cycle, air shall be flowed through the coupling at the rate of 100 to 188 pm at a total air pressure and temperature of 80 psia and 600°F, respectively. During the second hour there shall be no air flow. The coupling shall be released from the nipple following the 1-hour flow period and shall be re-engaged following the 1-hour no-flow period.

4.7 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preparation for delivery shall be examined for conformance with section 5.

5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Couplings shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116 in unit containers conforming to PPP-B-636.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Couplings shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with ASTM D-3951.

* 5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, C or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

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* 5.2.1 Level A. Couplings preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in overseas type containers conforming to PPP-B-601.

* 5.2.2 Level B. Couplings preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in fiberboard containers conforming to PPP-B-636, weather resistant, or wood containers conforming to PPP-B-601 or PPP-B-621, domestic type.

* 5.2.3 Level C. Couplings preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in fiberboard containers conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, or wood containers conforming to PPP-B-601 or PPP-B-621, domestic type.

* 5.2.4 Commercial. Couplings preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in accordance with requirements of ASTM D-3951.

* 5.2.5 Palletized loads. When specified (see 6.2), palletized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Palletized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent possible. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

* 5.3 Marking. Each unit pack, intermediate and exterior container and unitize load shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D-3951, if applicable, in addition to any special or other identification marking required by the contract (see 6.2).

* 5.4 General.

* 5.4.1 Exterior containers. Exterior containers (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, 5.2.3 and 5.2.4) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.7.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The couplings covered by this specification are intended for use with an aircraft mounted nipple for the purpose of connecting the aircraft with a ground service low pressure air supply for operation of an air turbine starter, air turbine motor or other pneumatically powered equipment. Use is limited to applications within the requirements of this specification.

6.2 Ordering data.

* 6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging, packing, marking and commercial/industrial (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

c. When palletized loads are required (see 5.4).

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6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualifications, awards will be made only for products which are at the time set for opening of bids, qualified for inclusion in the applicable Qualified Products List whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractor is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is the San Antonio Air Logistics Center, Engineering Division, ATTN: MMEDO, Kelly AFB, TX 78241, and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity.

6.3.1 When requested, the manufacturer shall submit engineering drawings and inspection reports.

* 6.3.2 The addition of attachment holes for MS18072 handling ring to a previously qualified coupling half shall not require that the coupling half be requalified.

6.4 International standardization. Certain provisions of this specification are the subject of international standardization agreements NATO STANAGs 3372 and 3947. When amendment, revision, or cancellation of this specification is proposed which will modify the international agreement concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate action through international standardization channels including departmental standardization offices to change the agreement or make other appropriate accommodations.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Air Force - 99
Navy - AS

International Interest (see 6.4)

Review activities:
DLA - CS

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 82

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-25531D	Coupling, Half, Quick Disconnect, Pneumatic Starter, External, Low Pressure

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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